

across the now defunct AmSpy Web site. He asked the US-based site owner James Johns to put up Sys Detective+ on the site.

Success At Last

A Web and graphic designer based in Phoenix, Arizona, Johns (27) is the CEO of Retina-X Studios. Johns says, "Prior to RXS, I ran a Web site called Amspy.com, which offered various spy software. Alam e-mailed me asking to add his product, Sys Detective+, to the site."

"It was then that we decided to launch a joint venture and create our own line of products. I had no apprehensions about the fact that Alam was a young collegian in India. Programmers in India have a good reputation in the US for quality outsourcing.

"Coders attending college in India are learning the latest skills—something even the most seasoned programmer may not usually provide. Next, we chalked out different duties for ourselves. Alam was to handle programming while I took care of the Web and graphic designing," says Johns.

A Profitable Alliance

Alam and James decided to divide the profits on an equal basis. Both play a key role in all management issues, project analysis, financial and marketing plans. It was thus that Retina-X Studios came into being, and was registered as a Limited Liability Company (LLC) in Nevada, USA, in September 2004.

By the time of his collaboration with Johns, Alam had upgraded his earlier creation of Sys Detective+, which Johns rechristened as 'AceSpy'.

AceSpy has sold over a thousand licenses so far. Other major software developed by Alam—all RXS products—include Net Spy Pro (a network spy software designed for network administrators), Key Spy Pro (which discreetly records all keystrokes), Screen-Spy (which, similar to a surveillance camera, records screen shots at intervals), and Eliminator-RX (an Internet cleaner software), among others.

AceSpy A Winner

AceSpy is a PC program that runs silently in the background, recording all activities performed

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AceSpy vis-a-vis Other Spy Software

Spy software is often sold as a spouse or child monitor, a surveillance tool or simply as a tool to spy on users who gain unauthorised access. Spy ware covertly gathers user information and activity without the user's knowledge. Essentially, whatever one does on the spy's computer is completely viewable by the spy.

- ❑ Popular spy software—apart from AceSpy—include 007 Spy Software, XPCSpy Pro, SpyBuddy, and Spector
- ❑ AceSpy happens to be the most feature-rich and affordable of them all
- ❑ The functions of most spy software include being in stealth mode, logging, filtering and blocking, and sending out alerts regarding PC activity
- ❑ Most of the above software don't log e-mail client activity, while AceSpy does
- ❑ Similarly, most of the above software don't log shell events
- ❑ AceSpy also features Webcam capture, makes a movie from the screenshots gathered, alerts via SMS, and delivers logged e-mails and chats instantly
- ❑ In terms of blocking features, AceSpy can block specific applications, and can perform a scheduled locking of the PC—which the competition cannot